

Offboarding Procedure

Final Pay

Departing employees receive their final paycheck, including any unused PTO payout, on the next regularly scheduled payroll date after their last day, or sooner where required by state law (several states require final pay immediately or within 72 hours for involuntary terminations, and Payroll tracks each state's specific deadline in the offboarding checklist tool).

Equipment Return

All company equipment (laptop, monitor, badge) must be returned within 5 business days of the last day of employment via prepaid shipping label provided by IT. Unreturned equipment may be deducted from final pay where permitted by state law, and IT remotely disables account access on the last day of employment regardless of whether equipment has yet been physically returned.

Benefits After Departure

Health benefits end on the last day of the month of departure. COBRA continuation coverage information is mailed within 14 days, and the departing employee has 60 days from the COBRA notice to elect continuation coverage, which if elected is retroactive to the day after Contoso Corp coverage ended so there is no coverage gap.

Exit Interview

Departing employees are invited to an optional exit interview with HR, conducted separately from the employee's manager, to gather candid feedback on their experience at Contoso Corp. Exit interview notes are anonymized and aggregated for department-level trend reporting; individual comments are not shared with the departing employee's former manager.

Employees who decline the live exit interview may instead complete a short written survey covering the same topic areas; either format is entirely optional, and declining both has no effect on final pay, references, or eligibility for rehire.

Rehire Eligibility

Employees who leave in good standing are generally eligible for rehire and may reapply for future openings at any time; their prior tenure does not automatically carry forward for benefits or PTO accrual purposes, since rehire is treated as a new hire date unless a specific rehire agreement states otherwise.

Non-Disclosure Reminder

As part of offboarding, HR reviews the confidentiality obligations from the Data Security and Confidentiality Policy with every departing employee, which continue to apply after departure regardless of the reason for leaving. Departing employees are asked to confirm in writing that they have not retained any Confidential data on personal devices or accounts.

Reference Requests

Contoso Corp provides only neutral employment verification (dates of employment and title) to external reference requests by default; a departing employee may request that their direct manager provide a more detailed personal reference, which is entirely the manager's individual choice to give, not a company-provided service.

Frequently Asked Questions

Will I still get my final bonus or commission payout if I resign before the payout date? This depends on the specific compensation plan governing that bonus or commission, not this general Offboarding Procedure; check your compensation plan document or ask HR, since some plans require active employment on the payout date and others prorate based on time worked.

Can I take my company laptop's personal files with me before returning it? IT can arrange a supervised transfer of clearly personal files (photos, personal documents) before wiping the device, but this must be scheduled in advance through the IT Service Desk and cannot happen after the device access has already been disabled.

Roles and Responsibilities

HR coordinates the overall offboarding timeline and conducts the exit interview. IT disables access and processes equipment returns. Payroll calculates and issues final pay including PTO payout. The departing employee's manager is responsible for a knowledge-transfer plan so ongoing work is not disrupted.

Knowledge Transfer Requirements

Departing employees, working with their manager, complete a Knowledge Transfer document covering active projects, key contacts, where important files and credentials live (without including actual passwords, which should never be written down), and any recurring task or deadline the employee normally owns. This is due before the employee's last day, and managers should build time for it into the employee's final two weeks rather than treating it as an afterthought.

For roles with significant client-facing responsibility, the manager also schedules a formal handoff call with the affected client before the employee's last day, so the client hears about the transition directly rather than discovering it after the fact.

Involuntary Termination Procedures

Involuntary terminations are conducted jointly by the manager and an HR Business Partner, never by a manager alone, to ensure consistency and legal compliance. The employee is provided a written notice of termination stating the effective date and, where applicable under state law, the reason. IT disables system access at the start of the termination meeting, not afterward, to reduce the risk of any data access issue during a sensitive conversation.